

LCB TRAINING

THE PARENT GUIDE

How to Be the Best Support System for Your Athlete

A practical guide for parents on how to support, encourage, and communicate with your young baseball player.

From Coach Broc | LCB Training | lcbtraining.com

A Note from Coach Broc

After 12+ years of working with youth and high school baseball players, I can tell you with certainty that parents who understand their role make an enormous difference in their athlete's development and enjoyment of the game.

This guide is not about criticizing parents — it is about giving you the tools and perspective to be the best possible support system for your athlete. The relationship between a player and their parents is one of the most powerful forces in youth sports. When it works well, it is rocket fuel for development. When it goes wrong, it can make even the most talented kid fall out of love with the game.

My goal is simple: I want your athlete to love baseball, work hard, build confidence, and be memorable. You are a huge part of making that happen.

"The most important thing your athlete needs from you is to feel loved — win or lose, hit or strikeout."

Section 1 — Understanding Your Role

As a parent, your role is not to be the coach. Your role is to be the safe place. Your athlete has coaches for coaching. They have teammates for competition. What only you can give them is unconditional support — a presence that says "I am proud of you no matter what happens on that field."

Role	Who Fills It	What It Looks Like
Coach	Coach Broc and their team coaches	Instruction, feedback, drills, game decisions
Teammate	Their teammates	Competition, camaraderie, accountability on the field
Safe Place	YOU — the parent	Unconditional love, encouragement, and stability after wins and losses

Section 2 — Sideline Behavior

What happens in the stands directly affects what happens on the field. Players hear their parents. They feel the energy. A tense, critical parent in the stands creates a tense, tentative player on the field. A calm, encouraging parent creates a confident, free athlete.

DO THIS	AVOID THIS
• Cheer for effort and hustle, not just results • Cheer for the whole team, not just your child • Stay calm and positive regardless of the score • Let the coaches coach without interference • Smile and give a thumbs up when your athlete looks at you • Celebrate good at-bats even without a hit • Save all feedback for after the game at the right time	• Shout mechanical instructions from the stands • Criticize the coach's decisions loudly • Show frustration or disappointment visibly during the game • Compare your athlete to other players • Argue with umpires — ever • Put pressure on your athlete before big games • Make the car ride home about what went wrong

Section 3 — The Car Ride Home

The car ride home after a game is one of the most important moments in youth sports. Research consistently shows that what athletes remember most from youth sports is how their parents made them feel — not the wins, not the stats.

The Car Ride Home — What to Say

- The single best thing you can say after any game: "I love watching you play."

- Wait for your athlete to bring up the game before you do. Let them lead.
- If they want to talk about it, listen first. Ask questions, do not lecture.
- If they are upset, validate the feeling: "I know that was frustrating." Then move on.
- Never give mechanical feedback in the car. That is Coach Broc's job.
- Celebrate with dinner or ice cream after the game regardless of the result.

Situation	Instead of...	Try This
After a loss	"Why did you throw to the wrong base?"	"That was a tough one. How are you feeling? Hungry?"
After a strikeout	"You need to stop swinging at that pitch."	"I saw you competing hard up there. Coach Broc will help you work on it."
After a great game	"Why didn't you get that last hit?"	"You were unbelievable today. I am so proud of you."
After an error	"You have to catch that ball."	"Shake it off. Every player makes errors. You will get the next one."
Before a big game	"You need to perform well today."	"Go have fun. Play your game. I will be cheering for you."

Section 4 — Working with Coaches

A healthy parent-coach relationship makes everything better for your athlete. Coaches want to hear from parents — but at the right time and about the right things.

DO THIS

- Reach out via email or scheduled call, not at the field
- Ask how you can support your athlete's development at home
- Share relevant personal information the coach should know
- Express concerns calmly and respectfully
- Trust that the coach has a plan even when you disagree
- Thank the coach for their time and investment in your athlete

AVOID THIS

- Approach the coach right after a tough loss
- Question playing time in a confrontational way
- Undermine the coach's authority in front of your athlete
- Have your athlete deliver complaints on your behalf
- Copy other parents on complaint emails
- Compare your athlete's playing time to other players

Section 5 — Building Confidence at Home

Confidence is not just built on the field. The words your athlete hears at home shape how they see themselves as a player and as a person. Here are practical things you can do every day.

Focus on Effort, Not Outcome

Praise your athlete for how hard they worked, not just the results. "You really battled up there" means more than "good job getting a hit."

Ask the Right Questions

Instead of "how did you do?" try "what was the most fun part today?" or "what did you learn?" This shifts focus from performance to experience.

Let Them Struggle

Resist the urge to fix everything. Struggle is how athletes grow. Let Coach Broc handle the instruction — your job is to encourage through the tough moments.

Remind Them Why They Play

When things get hard, reconnect them to why they love the game. Not for scholarships or stats — but for the love of competing and being part of a team.

Model Resilience

How you handle your own setbacks teaches your athlete how to handle theirs. Show them what it looks like to stay positive and keep working through adversity.

"Your athlete will forget most of the games. They will never forget how you made them feel."

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